operated in the country since 2004. The Moatize mine opened the doors to the mining company. Vale brought to the country the major Brazilian construction companies Odebrecht, Camargo Corrêa and Andrade Gutierrez. Initially, the project centred on coal mining in Moatize, Tete, with exports through the Beira port. The Moatize mine has already gone through expansions and Vale is also involved in the construction of the Nacala Corridor in the area. The huge project involves the duplication of the railroad to allow iron ore exports through the Nacala port in Nampula and aims at the consolidation of a privileged logistical corridor to African countries and Asia through the Indian Ocean.[11]

Moreover, Vale also has the control of the country's biggest railways owned by the Nacala Integrated Logistics Corridor, a partnership between Vale (80%) and Railroads of Mozambique (20%). The company has already invested around US$1.9 billion in the mining and port complex.[12] Vale investments in the region are backed by the Brazilian cooperation agencies for agriculture, particularly the Program of Triangular Co-operation for Agricultural Development of the Tropical Savannahs of Mozambique (ProSavana). As an interviewee remarked, 'Nacala is the booster of Brazilian agribusiness' internationalisation.'[13]

As opposed to evaluations of Odebrecht's operation in Angola, the Mozambican interviewees revealed that initial expectations of job creation and local development stemming from Vale's operations did not occur. This can be explained by the low capacity of the Mozambican government to negotiate and inspect the actions of a company with the economic power of Vale. As one informant argued, 'the government was taken by surprise by the dynamics and the new projects the company was bringing to the city.'[14] In addition, also contrary to Odebrecht, Vale did not foster social and entrepreneurial accountability, did little advertising and did not assess the qualifications of local workers for its projects. Only recently, after a great deal of negotiation with the Mozambican government, the company was obliged to contribute to a Tete training centre in partnership with Odebrecht and Keltz.

Although in operation more recently than Odebrecht, Vale does not depend on the intermediation of the Brazilian government to promote investments in Mozambique either. The mining company has full access and great bargaining power to negotiate with the government and impose its interests. Facing a population less experienced in formal work, Vale's arrival in Tete has been followed by allegations such as excessive hiring of outside workers (either from other regions of the country or other African countries) and discriminating against local workers in favour of Brazilians. This allegation deepened the company's conflicts with both workers and local communities.